



The Trussell Trust's UK foodbank network



Emergency food for UK people in crisis

www.trusselltrust.org

Reg. Charity No. 1110522 - Reg. Ltd. Co. No. 5434524 - Reg. in England & Wales

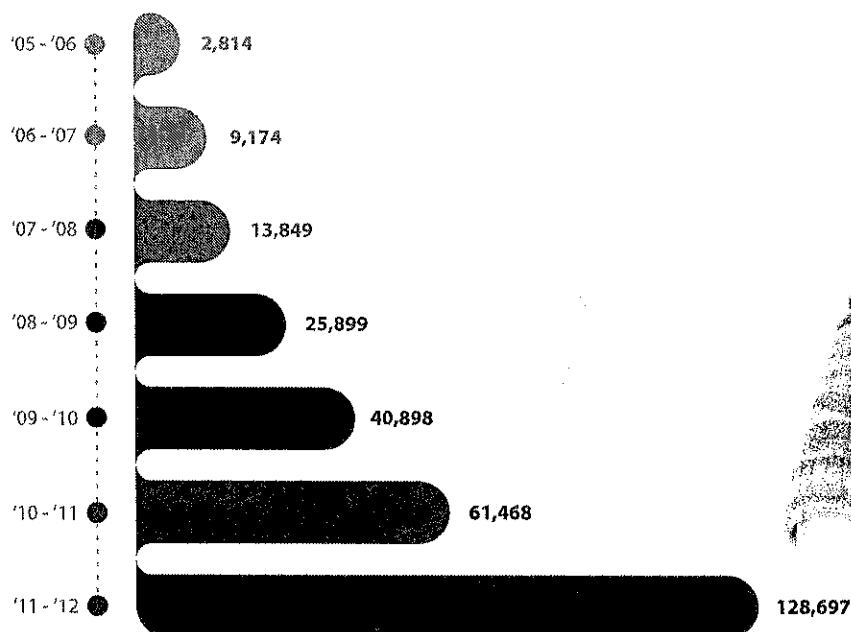
THE TRUSSELL TRUST FOODBANK NETWORK IN 2012: An introduction

The Trussell Trust's UK foodbank network partners with communities nationwide to launch foodbanks that provide three days of emergency food to men, women and children in crisis.

The economic downturn has seen the need for foodbanks soar right across the UK. New foodbanks are opening at the rate of three a week and the number of people fed by foodbanks has doubled to almost 130,000 in the last year alone.

The simple, practical gift of food and support at the point of crisis changes lives.

The use of a highly effective and pioneering social franchise model has enabled The Trussell Trust to respond incredibly quickly, sensitively and effectively to the growing need for emergency food in the UK by helping communities to start foodbanks. In April 2012 The Trussell Trust launched our 200th UK foodbank a year ahead of our target. Our vision is to have a foodbank in every town, creating a nation where no-one has to go hungry.



Numbers of people fed by foodbanks
nationwide between April 2005 - April 2012



THE BEGINNINGS OF SOMETHING BIG...

Our history

'I can't feed my children tonight and I live around the corner from you in Salisbury'

- a local mum to Trussell Trust founder, Paddy Henderson, 1999

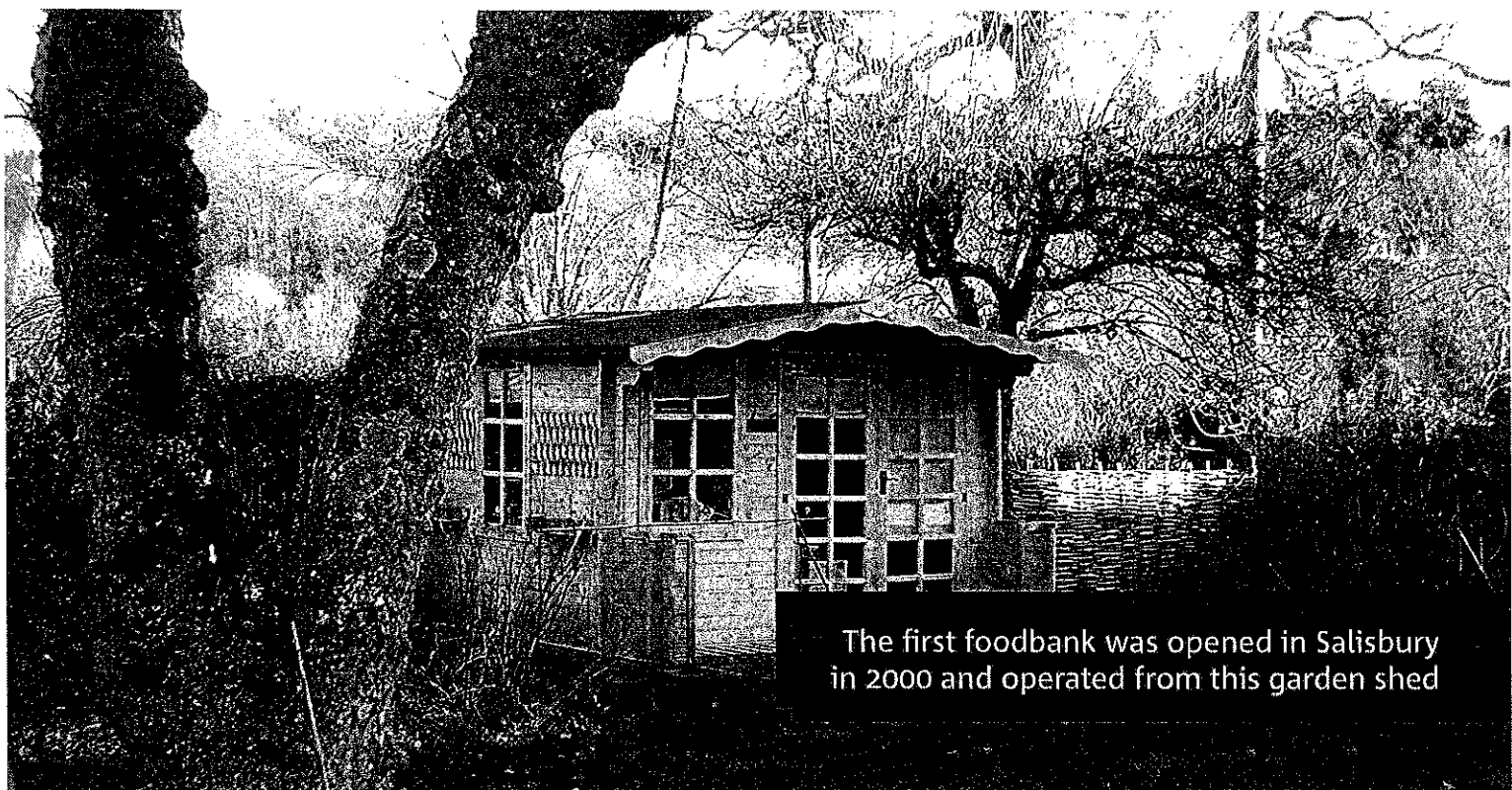
A phone call from a distressed Salisbury mum in 1999 triggered the start of a nationwide network of foodbanks that has since given emergency food to over 374,000 people in crisis across the UK.

At the time of the phonecall, Trussell Trust founders Paddy and Carol Henderson were working in Bulgaria with abandoned children but this call prompted them to research the problem of 'hidden hunger' on their own doorstep in Salisbury. They were shocked by what they found. Local indices of deprivation combined with reports from social services confirmed that thousands of people on low incomes hit crisis and struggle to feed themselves and their families as a result.

Paddy and Carol Henderson's response to the problem of short-term hunger was innovative and practical – they set up a 'foodbank', in their garden shed. The public 'deposited' non-perishable food and 'withdrawals' were made by those in need, when they produced a properly authorised voucher. To be sure that they were reaching those in genuine need, they asked frontline care professionals (social workers, doctors, teachers etc) to act as their ears and eyes in the community, and to issue foodbank vouchers.

In its first year, Salisbury foodbank fed 600 people and each year the numbers fed grew. Salisbury was not the only community with 'hidden hunger'; this was an idea which had the potential to help thousands of people around the country. How could others be helped to avoid the mistakes they had made and be empowered to set up their own foodbank quickly and efficiently? In 2004, we developed one of the UK's first social franchises: the foodbank network.

Since 2004 The Trussell Trust has launched over 250 foodbanks nationwide.

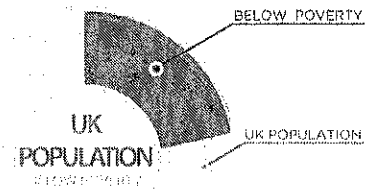


13 MILLION PEOPLE LIVE BELOW THE POVERTY LINE IN THE UK*

*Source: government indices of deprivation

UK POPULATION
63,047,162

PEOPLE LIVING BELOW
THE POVERTY LINE
13,500,000



1 in 5 people live in poverty in the UK. Many families hit crisis and cannot afford food. Today, people are going hungry in their own homes. Rising food and fuel prices, static incomes, high unemployment and changes to benefits are causing many families to struggle to put food on the table.

The economic downturn has caused the number of people needing foodbanks to grow significantly.

WHO DO FOODBANKS HELP?

Many foodbank clients are low income families hit by a crisis that is not their fault such as redundancy, reduced working hours or something as seemingly small as an unexpected bill. Others are victims of domestic violence, people experiencing benefit delay or facing debt problems or those hit by illness.

Often foodbank clients face decisions between eating and paying the rent. Some are so desperate that they consider stealing to feed their children. A recent report by Netmums found that 1 in every 5 mums regularly skip meals to feed their children. Foodbanks meet mothers in this situation every day.



Less than five per cent of foodbank clients are homeless, many are working families. Typically, one third of foodbank recipients are children.

HOW DOES A FOODBANK WORK?

Foodbanks are run by the community for the community: non-perishable food is donated by local people – schools, businesses, churches and individuals. Volunteers of all backgrounds help run foodbanks by packing, sorting and distributing the food. Every client is referred to the foodbank by a frontline care professional such as a doctor or social worker. Foodbanks are an emergency food service: to prevent dependency on foodbanks our clients are entitled to up to three consecutive foodbank vouchers. To help clients break out of poverty, we signpost clients to organisations able to resolve the underlying problem.

Food parcels have been designed by dieticians to provide recipients with nutritionally balanced food for three days. Rural foodbanks often operate delivery services to reach those unable to get to a foodbank.

STEP 1



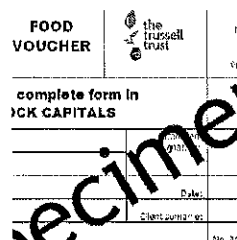
Non-perishable food is donated by the public

STEP 2



Volunteers sort and pack food into emergency food boxes

STEP 3



Frontline care professionals such as doctors and social workers give foodbank vouchers to people in crisis

STEP 4



Foodbank vouchers are exchanged for 3 days of food at a distribution centre

STEP 5



Foodbanks take time to listen and signpost clients to further support

FOODBANKS: EVIDENCE OF IMPACT

'Many clients would have been without food for a considerable length of time without access to the foodbank' - Citizens Advice Bureau

'It's very hard to look at your baby and not be able to feed him, but with your help today I was able to, so thank you very much.' - Low income working couple, London

The numbers:

people fed in **2011-12**
128,697

>> Trussell Trust foodbanks fed 128,697 people nationwide in 2011-12 financial year, 100 per cent more than the previous year. Numbers fed by our foodbanks have risen by 397 per cent since 2008.

>> In the last 12 months alone we have launched 100 foodbanks nationwide. The exceptional need, a growing awareness of foodbanks and our highly effective social franchising model has enabled The Trussell Trust to launch three new foodbanks per week in 2012, compared to two per week in the previous year. We currently have over 250 foodbanks launched nationwide to date.

3 new
foodbanks
launched
every week

Impacting lives

>> Responses from both care professionals and beneficiaries confirm that the foodbanks' timely interventions at times of dire need prevent the escalation of short term crisis into crime, housing loss, family breakdown and mental health problems. A recent survey of Welsh foodbanks showed that:

*100% clients would have skipped meals without the foodbank
69% would have experienced increased depression
38% would have experienced strain on family relationships
15% would have committed a crime [to obtain food]
8% would have used a loan shark or doorstep lender*

Over **250**
UK foodbanks
launched



>> Foodbanks create a warm, welcoming environment to help recipients to feel at ease. Foodbanks make time for people. Volunteers are trained to provide a listening ear over a cup of tea and sometimes this makes the biggest difference. 24 year-old James told us:

'Getting food from the foodbank really helped to reduce stress but it wasn't just the food, it was the welcome that was brilliant. Just talking to someone who genuinely cared for ten minutes changed my perspective. It gave me the confidence I needed to keep on applying for jobs and now I've got one. Without the foodbank I'd still be homeless and on the dole. The foodbank is the best thing in the world.'



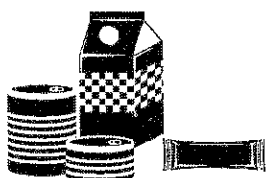
4,360
volunteers in 2011-12

Building community and volunteering opportunities

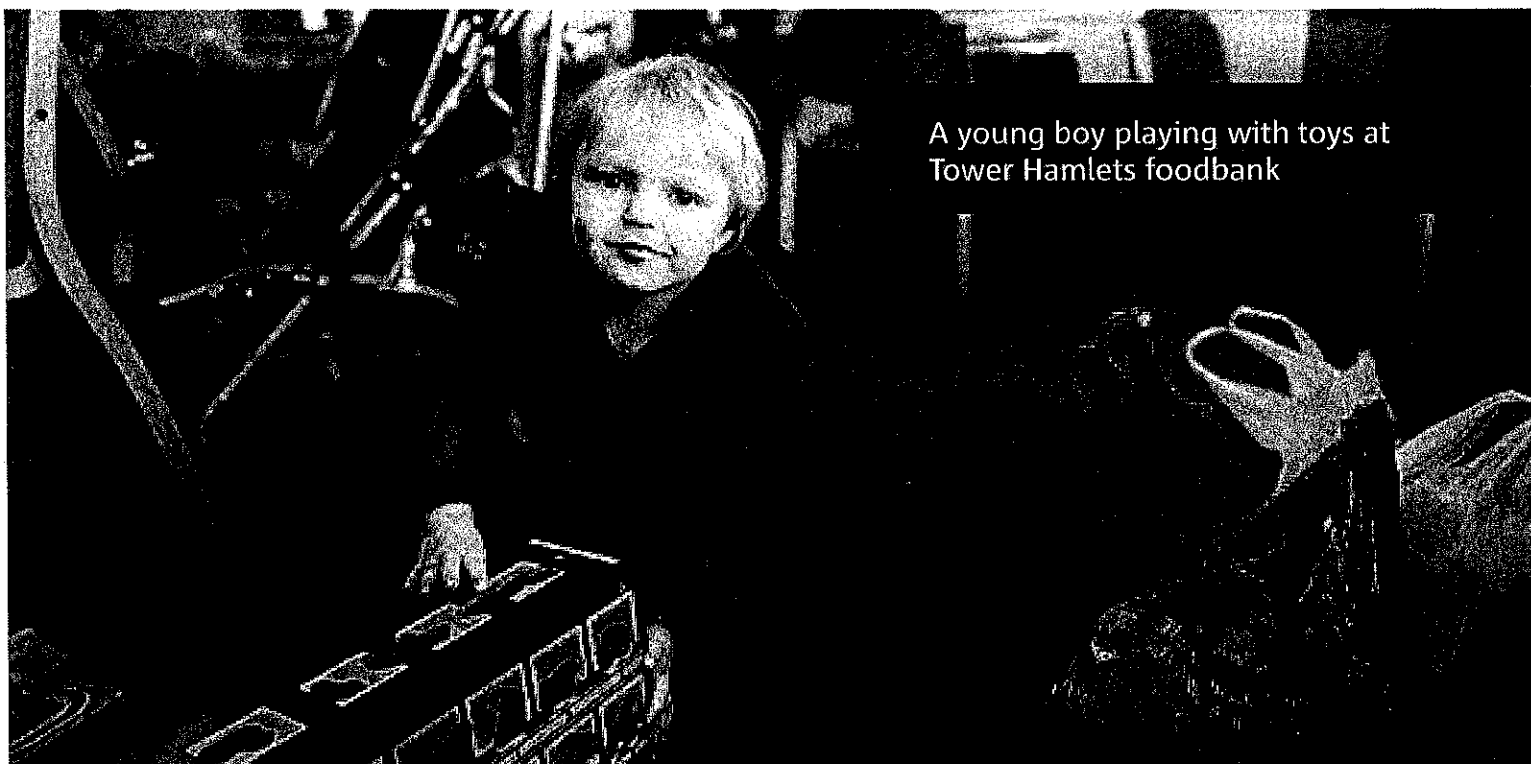
>> As well as providing emergency food and support to thousands of people every year, foodbanks also encourage communities to work together across social divides to provide a vital service for the neediest members.

>> In 2011-12 over 4,360 people volunteered at foodbanks across the UK, including 162 supported volunteers with social, physical or mental difficulties. Volunteering at foodbanks has proven benefits. 96% of volunteers at Welsh foodbanks said that volunteering increased their sense of wellbeing and helped them to make friends, 92% said it helped them to understand people's needs and 73% said their self-esteem increased.

1,200 tonnes of
food donated in
12 months



>> Over 90% food given out by foodbanks is donated by the general public, including individuals, schools, businesses and churches. Last year 1200 tonnes of food was donated in 12 months.



A young boy playing with toys at Tower Hamlets foodbank

CASE STUDIES

I hadn't eaten for days to feed my children'

William, 27, gave up his job at the Odeon to start a career in the Army to provide a secure future for his family. Will's income decreased as food prices rose. Whilst he was away on basic training his wife Annie, 25, started going without food to feed their two young daughters. The family had not been provided with army accommodation and were living in a one bedroom flat with their two daughters aged four and 18 months. Determined not to get into debt, Annie was forced to go without food to pay the bills and feed her children. The increasing stress and hunger overwhelmed Annie when dropping off her daughter at nursery one day. She broke down in tears and they referred her to the foodbank. She said 'now that I have food I feel able to face the rest of my difficulties.' The family are now in military accommodation and are back on their feet.

Funeral expenses meant we couldn't afford food' says 13-year-old Sophie

When 13-year-old Sophie's father became terminally ill, her mum gave up work to look after him. When he passed away, the situation got dramatically worse as the grieving family found themselves crippled by funeral costs and unable to afford food.

Chesham Foodbank gave the family enough emergency food to help them through their crisis. Sophie said 'it was such a massive help and the people there were really kind.' She said that the food parcel helped them to get back on their feet and that without it 'it would have been impossible to cope.'

Receiving a food parcel helped to reduce the family's anxiety and meant that they could concentrate on supporting each other, Sophie said that the foodbank 'made it a little bit easier to feel better'.

Police take desperate shoplifter to foodbank

Rather than arresting a young man when he was caught shoplifting in Islington, police officers took him to the foodbank recently. Adam had not eaten for four days and had finally resorted to stealing bread and eggs from a local shop. After experiencing 23 days benefit delay Adam had tried begging for food and was desperate. Arrested by plain clothes officers, he was distraught at having been forced to turn to crime to feed himself. Fortunately, the police officers were so moved by his plight that they took him to Islington Foodbank. Adam cried with gratitude when he saw the bags of food and the police were so impressed by the foodbank service that they asked to become official foodbank voucher holders.



'We were going to eat beans on toast for Christmas dinner'

'I cried with joy when our foodbank Christmas hamper was delivered,' says Mandi, a mother of two, 'it was such a relief: we were going to eat beans on toast for Christmas dinner but instead we could have a festive feast.'

Despite being a working family, reduced hours and salary had left the family unable to make ends meet as the additional costs of winter took their toll. 'We had to choose between paying for food, heating or rent' says Mandi. 'It's so hard to tell your two young children that they can't have any Christmas presents or a dinner like their friends. Thanks to our food hamper we could sit down and eat together as a family for the first time in weeks. We'd been telling the children we'd eat when they'd gone to bed, but the reality was we were going without. Salisbury foodbank made our Christmas, it was the best we've ever had.'

'Escaping domestic abuse meant that I ended up at a foodbank'

Alison, 59, sobbed as she told her story at a foodbank centre recently. Having worked all her life she was so embarrassed to have to turn to a charity to be able to eat. The problem came when she finally escaped from a long and abusive marriage. Sharing a workplace with her husband, she had to leave her employment. After sending hundreds of job applications without success, Alison found herself without anything. Her friends couldn't help anymore and she was trying to support her son too. In despair, she turned to the foodbank for help. After years of abuse she was so moved by the care she received from the foodbank team that she said her hope in people had been restored and 'I was made to feel I belonged to the human race.'

'I was malnourished and went without food or heating during coldest week of the year'

21 year-old college student Gemma had not eaten properly for weeks and could not afford gas to heat her flat when she came to the foodbank in January. After leaving state care she was determined to make something of her life and was funding herself through college. Working two evening jobs to make ends meet, she was made redundant from both within a month. As a 21-year-old in full time education with no children she did not qualify for benefits. She sold everything she had and, with nowhere else to turn, she asked her local councillor for help; they referred her to the foodbank. When she arrived she was ill, dehydrated and in the first stages of malnutrition. For Gemma, the foodbank was a life saver. She says she has no idea what she would have done without it. She was so impressed by the support she received that she began volunteering at the foodbank.

'The foodbank is a second family to me, they look beyond my difficulties'

Despite suffering from cerebral palsy, Charlie, 31, leads the volunteers at Salisbury foodbank centre every Tuesday and is the longest standing foodbank volunteer in the country. Her disability meant that her application to volunteer was turned down at many other charities but her kind, warm manner has been invaluable at the foodbank. Charlie has now been volunteering for The Trussell Trust for 11 years and recently carried the Olympic torch in recognition of her contribution to the local community. Charlie says 'It is a great feeling to go home after a day at the foodbank centre knowing that someone won't go hungry that night. If I didn't come to The Trussell Trust, I'd be sitting at home on my own. Coming here gives me a purpose.' The Trussell Trust's supported volunteer programme recognises the valuable contribution that people of all backgrounds and abilities can make in their local communities.

'Feeding our children during the school holidays tipped us over the edge'

For agricultural engineer Ed and his wife Lizzie, the recession has been all too real. A pretty village in the Cotswolds is not where you expect to find poverty but rural poverty can bite hardest. Ed, Lizzie and their children are victims of the economic downturn. After time off due to a back injury, Ed struggled to find enough work to pay the bills. When the school holidays began and the children did not have access to free school meals, Ed and Lizzie started going without food to make sure that the children were fed.

North Cotswold Foodbank manager James Milton says: 'The combination of higher living costs and lower earnings puts immense pressure on working people in rural communities. The majority of our clients are working families. The national minimum wage might be sufficient for survival in towns, where amenities are within walking distance. In rural communities, it cannot stretch to the additional costs of essential travel, higher prices, and higher domestic energy costs. To achieve an acceptable standard of living, an urban parent with one child needs to earn £6.37 per hour, for a parent in a village this figure jumps to £10.13. There's an old saying in the countryside: "You can't eat the view", it's more true today than ever.'

'Changes to my ESA left me with no money for food'

Edna, almost 60, was referred to the foodbank by a cancer charity after her Employment Support Allowance was replaced by Job Seeker's Allowance. Despite having undergone radical surgery to remove cancer last year and suffering from arthritis and depression following the recent death of her brother, Edna was told she was fit for work. She has been applying for jobs with little success and feels that her age has reduced her employability. She is also concerned that she would not be able to physically cope with a job and is appealing the decision but this is expected to take weeks. Edna lives alone and has sold her TV, a main source of company for her, to help put food on the table and has been eating plain pasta or couscous as it's all she can afford. She contacted the foodbank with just £8 left to last her five days.

**some names have been changed to protect identity*



Foodbank volunteer Charlie with the Olympic torch

MEETING THE NEED:

How you can become part of the solution to hidden hunger in the UK

Thousands of people across the UK received emergency food from foodbanks last year, but thousands more live in towns with no foodbank. To stop people going hungry The Trussell Trust is working tirelessly to encourage more communities and churches to open foodbanks nationwide. We urgently need to generate much-needed funds to underpin this exceptional growth.

By supporting The Trussell Trust's foodbank network, you will help to prevent people from going hungry in their own homes. You will help to stop parents from skipping meals to feed their children, or people having to decide between eating and paying the rent.

Your support will encourage local communities to be part of the solution to local food poverty.

These emails are from people in crisis nationwide who have asked us for help. Some are from people in towns where there are no foodbanks, highlighting the urgent need for foodbanks in communities right across the UK.

Hi was wondering if I can get help with food. I work on low income and can't afford to feed myself and my 2 boys

- Email, 10th August 2012

Hi! I would like to enquire about receiving a food parcel. I am a mature student at uni but due to my dla being stopped in may I have had no money since the end of july when I spent the last of my student grant. I have managed to survive till now by using what I had stocked and from the help from my mother, however she is a pensioner.

I have had a tribunal and my dla is going to be backdated but I will not receive payment for about a month, I also get my next student grant in 2 weeks. I am deaf so cannot use the telephone to enquire. If someone could help me I will willingly donate either money or food stuff as soon as I am able!

- Email, 5th September 2012

I'm a single parent to 2 young boys aged 8 and 11 and have been for 8 yrs now. The 8 yr old has Autism, and special needs. Up to November 2011 I worked to pay bills and support my family, but then I was made redundant.

Now paying a mortgage, and other household bills, I live off crisps and bananas, so my kids are fed. I suffer from depression now and I'm always falling asleep, I think it's due to not eating, my boys mean everything to me and I'm worried that if they're not getting enough food they will be taken away. Please can you help. I am so embarrassed as I am a good mum who doesn't like being defeated [sic] by anything, but I can't manage. Sorry to ask. Thank you. - Email, 10th August 2012

How and where can I access foodbank? I am off work on stat sick pay struggling to put food on the table. I am resorted to one meal a day of pasta with butter

- Email, 6th August 2012

**Our Vision: A FOODBANK IN EVERY UK TOWN
A NATION WHERE NO-ONE NEEDS TO GO HUNGRY**



The foodbank network is part of The Trussell Trust

The Trussell Trust empowers local communities to combat poverty and marginalisation in the UK and Bulgaria. We develop innovative, sustainable projects such as foodbanks, community shops and supported volunteering programmes in the UK as well as opening Houses of Opportunity for orphanage leavers in Bulgaria. We work with the people that society forgets, providing practical help and enabling each person to realise that they are valued. Our vision is to build communities where people of all backgrounds are included and have the opportunity to live in dignity with hope for the future.

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